The Lab Report: April 2026

Insights Beyond The Diagnosis

Neutrophilic Dermatoses: Don't Miss the Hematologic Clue

Benchmark Diagnostics

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Sweet's Syndrome


NDDH


Pyoderma Gangrenosum


Ertthema Elevatum Diutinum

When Neutrophils Tell a Bigger Story

What You See in the Clinic

- *Painful erythematous plaques (Sweet syndrome).*
- *Violaceous plaques on the dorsal hand. (Neutrophilic dermatosis of the dorsal hand, a localized variant of Sweet's syndrome)*
- *Rapidly progressive ulcers with undermined borders (pyoderma gangrenosum)*
- *Soft and red lesions progress to firm, fibrous, and yellow-brown on the dorsal surfaces of extremities (Erythema elevatum diutinum)*
- *Fever, malaise, leukocytosis*
- *Lesions are sterile despite dramatic inflammation*

What We See on the Slide

- *Dense neutrophilic infiltrate in dermis*
- *Papillary dermal edema*
- *Leukocytoclasia ("nuclear dust")*
- *Absence of organisms on stains*

Clinical Pearls

- Neutrophilic Dermatoses may precede hematologic malignancy
- Associated with Acute Myelogenous Leukemia, Myelodysplastic Syndrome, and other hematologic disorders including gammopathies
- Skin findings may appear months before diagnosis
- Sweet's syndrome has the strongest association
- Myelodysplastic syndrome can be associated with all three conditions: Sweet's, PG, and EED

Weiss EH, Ko CJ, Leung TH, Micheletti RG, Mostaghimi A, Ramachandran SM, Rosenbach M, Nelson CA. Neutrophilic Dermatoses: a Clinical Update. Curr Dermatol Rep. 2022;11(2):89-102. doi: 10.1007/s13671-022-00355-8. Epub 2022 Mar 16. PMID: 35310367; PMCID: PMC8924564.

"Questions or cases to discuss? We're always happy to review."

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